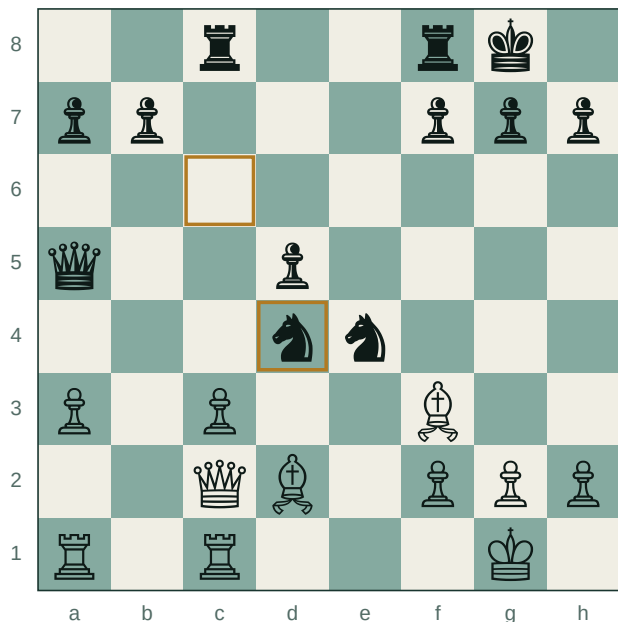


Discovered attacks: White, move 17

Discovered attacks

White to move



Previous move: 16...Nxd4. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

17. cxd4 Rxc2 18. Bxa5

17.cxd4 The pawn captures the knight on d4. The changed line means the bishop on d2 attacks the queen on a5. Recorded reply: **17...Rxc2**.

18.Bxa5 The bishop captures the queen on a5.

At the end, nominal material is White 21 / Black 19 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, White's balance changes by +3. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does White's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +3: the balance goes from -1 to +2. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

Choose the blocker's destination carefully. An uncovered attack may fail if the opponent has a stronger check or can capture the slider.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

Moving a blocker can uncover a rook, bishop, or queen attack. The moving piece may create a second threat, giving the defender too many problems at once.

HOW TO LOOK

Find a friendly piece between a slider and an enemy target, then inspect its forcing moves and captures.

The defending king is on g8. Geometrically undefended: queen on a5 and knight on d4. Check for tactical protection.